

Dealer Group Analysis

Pentana Vehicle Sales — Australia

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Universe: 2,128 retail proxy keys · 4.9M VINs · 329 unique dealer groups · 74.1% of VINs flow through a named group

How the Dealer Groups Were Built

The Challenge

The raw Pentana data contains 2,142 dealer proxy keys (DEALERPOSTCODE_CLEAN × MAKE), each representing a unique dealer-brand pairing. Of these, 2,128 are active retail proxy keys linked to the Silver table. The goal was to assign every proxy key to its real corporate dealer group — replacing an initial algorithmic estimate with web-verified, ground-truth ownership data.

9-Tier Resolution Pipeline

A tiered pipeline was built, progressing from highest-confidence (direct web verification) to lowest-confidence (algorithmic fallback). Each tier only processes dealers not yet resolved by a higher tier.

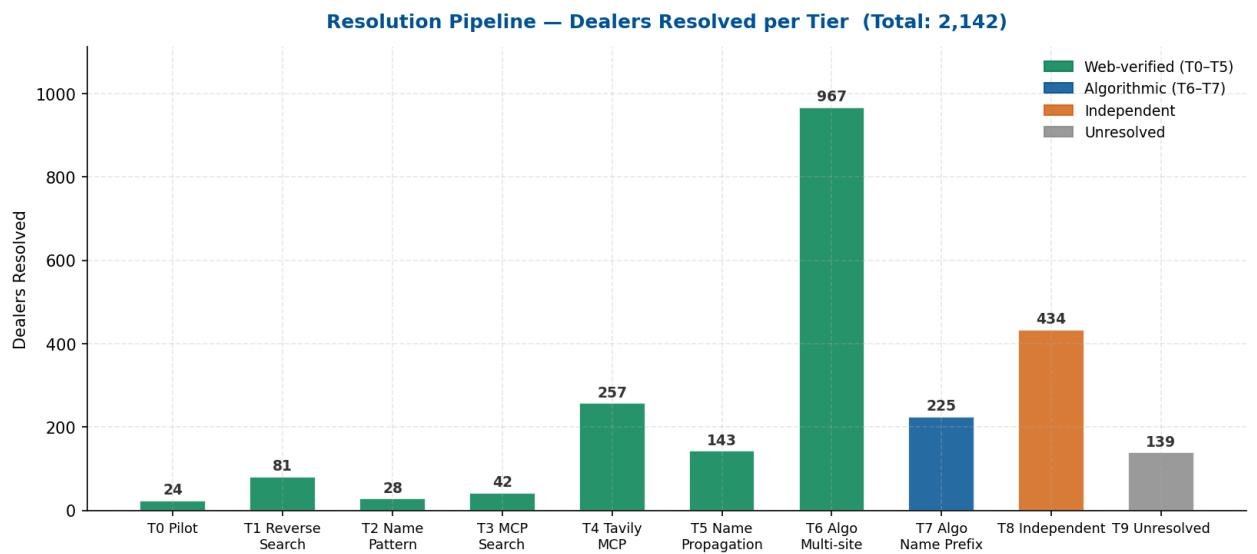


Figure 1: *
Resolution Pipeline — dealers resolved per tier across all 2,142 proxy keys

Tier	Method	Rows	Confidence	Description
T0	Pilot (prior session)	24	HIGH	Confirmed from earlier Tavily MCP pilot run
T1	Web reverse search	81	HIGH	Direct dealer-name match to web-listed group entities
T2	Name pattern	28	MEDIUM	Prefix propagation from T1 confirmed anchors
T3	MCP search	42	HIGH	Manual Tavily MCP confirmed entries
T4	Tavily MCP search	257	HIGH/ME	Bulk dealer-level web search via Tavily API
T5	Name propagation	143	MEDIUM	Prefix rules derived from T4 confirmations
T6	Algo multi-site	967	MEDIUM	Shared-address clustering (verified grouping, placeholder names resolved via anchor search)
T7	Algo name prefix	225	MEDIUM	Name-prefix clustering cross-referenced with group audit
T8	Independent	434	HIGH	No group ownership signal found — standalone dealer
T9	Unresolved	139	LOW	No dealer reference found in any source
Total		2,142		

Table 1: *
Resolution tier breakdown — all 2,142 dealer proxy keys

Quality Assurance

Following the automated pipeline, several quality passes were run:

- **Geographic placeholder detection** — 63 suburb/city names used as placeholder group names were identified and resolved via targeted anchor searches (e.g. “Ferntree Gully” → CD Motor Group, “Valley” → Valley Motor Group).
- **T5 over-propagation checks** — name-prefix rules were validated to ensure geographic names (e.g. “Gold Coast”) did not incorrectly tag unrelated dealers.
- **Artifact removal** — manufacturer locator pages (Stellantis, Isuzu UTE Australia) and corporate HQ entries (Subaru HQ, Ford HQ) were excluded from retail counts.
- **Group name normalisation** — raw algorithmic names cleaned to proper group names (e.g. “John McGrath” → McGrath Automotive Group, “Barbagallo” → Barbagallo Automotive Group).

Coverage Summary

VIN Coverage by Category

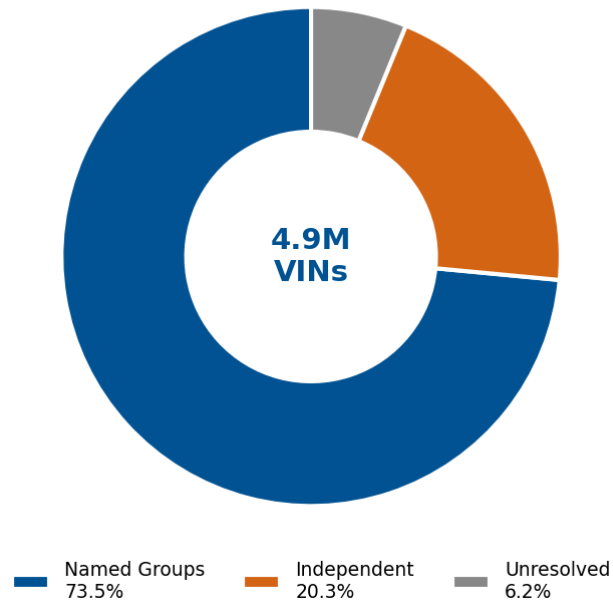


Figure 2: *

VIN Coverage — share of 4.9M retail VINs by category

Category	Dealers	Dealer %	VINs	VIN %
Named dealer groups	1,506	70.8%	3,630,711	74.1%
Independent (no group)	380	17.9%	993,790	20.3%
Unresolved	134	6.3%	273,789	5.6%
Manufacturer locators (artifact)	108	5.1%	349	<0.1%
Total (retail)	2,128	100%	4,898,639	100%

Group-affiliated dealers account for **74.1%** of VIN volume despite representing only 70.8% of proxy keys — confirming higher average throughput per group site vs independent. 108 manufacturer dealer-locator entries were identified and excluded as artifacts (<0.1% of VINs).

Top Groups by VIN Volume

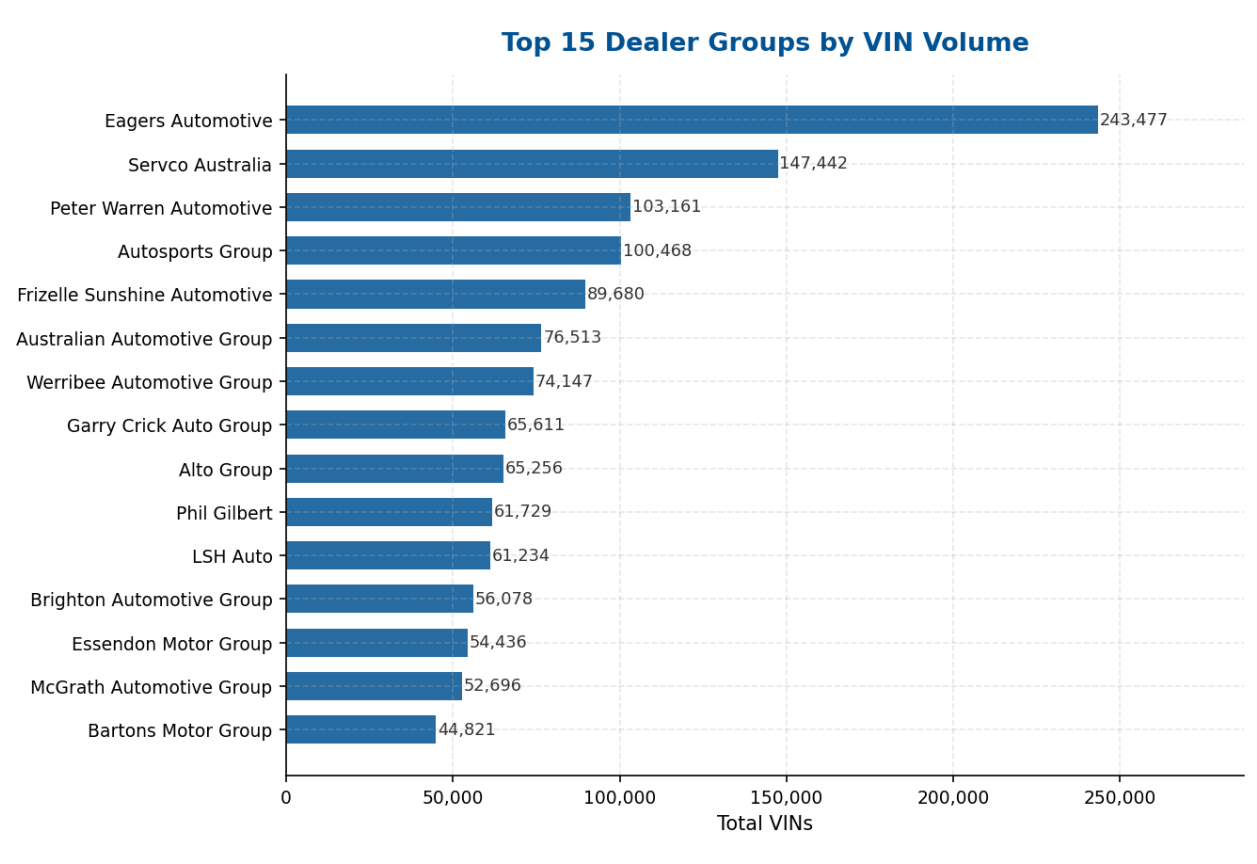


Figure 3: *
Top 15 Dealer Groups by total VIN volume (Silver table, IS_RETAIL_DEALER = TRUE)

#	Group	Dealers	Total VINs	VIN Share
1	Eagers Automotive	22	243,477	4.97%
2	Servco Australia	12	147,442	3.01%
3	Peter Warren Automotive	20	103,161	2.11%
4	Autosports Group	12	100,468	2.05%
5	Frizelle Sunshine Automotive	16	89,680	1.83%
6	Australian Automotive Group	19	76,014	1.55%
7	Werribee Automotive Group	25	74,147	1.51%
8	Garry Crick Auto Group	37	65,467	1.34%
9	Alto Group	18	65,256	1.33%
10	Phil Gilbert	4	61,729	1.26%
11	LSH Auto	1	60,636	1.24%
12	Brighton Automotive Group	11	56,078	1.14%
13	Essendon Motor Group	13	54,436	1.11%
14	McGrath Automotive Group	22	52,696	1.08%
15	Bartons Motor Group	17	44,821	0.91%
Top 5 combined		82	684,228	14.0%
Top 10 combined		165	1,026,841	21.0%

Top Groups by Dealer Count & Efficiency

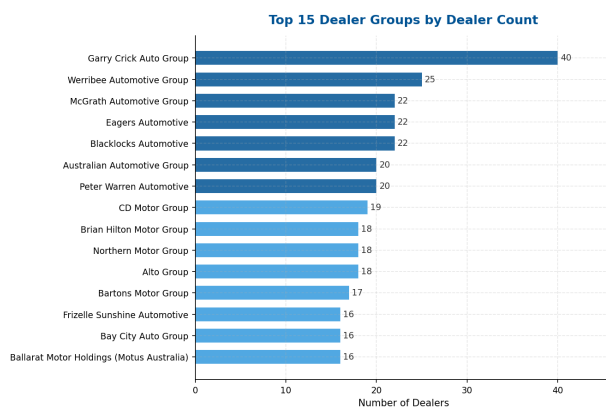


Figure 4: *
Dealer Count — top 15 groups

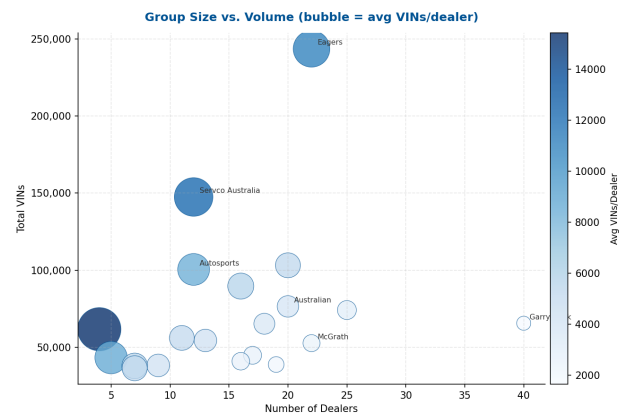


Figure 5: *
Size vs Volume — bubble = avg VINs/dealer

The efficiency scatter reveals a clear split: **Phil Gilbert** (15,432 VINs/dealer) and **LSH Auto** (60,636 VINs/dealer — single proxy key) are extreme outliers, while **Eagers** (11,131 VINs/dealer) and **Servco** (12,287 VINs/dealer) lead among multi-site groups. **Garry Crick** operates the widest footprint (37 dealers) but at a lower per-dealer average, reflecting a highly diversified brand portfolio.

Geographic Spread

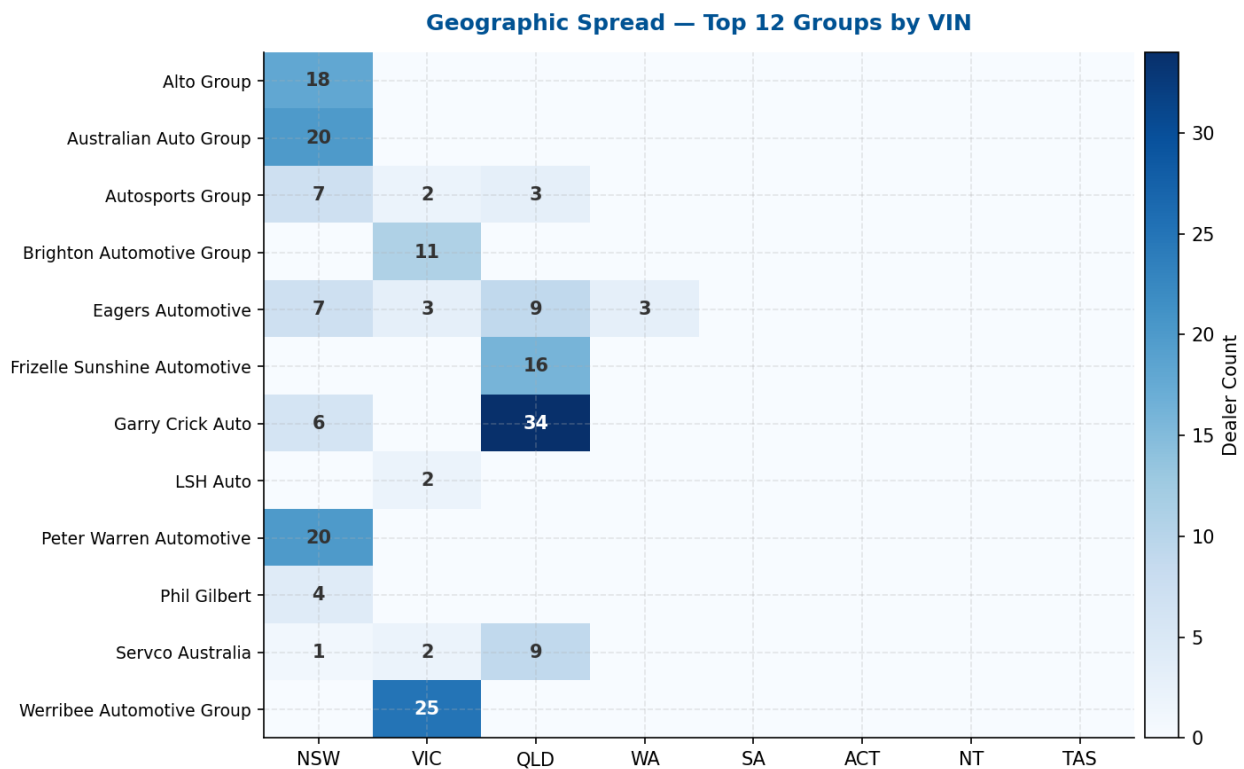


Figure 6: *

Geographic Heatmap — dealer count by group and state (top 12 groups by VIN, Silver table)

Group	States Active	Dealers per State
Eagers Automotive	QLD, NSW, VIC, WA	9 QLD / 7 NSW / 3 VIC / 2 WA
Servco Australia	QLD, VIC, NSW	9 QLD / 2 VIC / 1 NSW
Peter Warren Automotive	NSW only	20 NSW
Autosports Group	NSW, QLD, VIC	7 NSW / 3 QLD / 2 VIC
Frizelle Sunshine Automotive	QLD only	16 QLD
Australian Automotive Group	NSW only	19 NSW
Werribee Automotive Group	VIC only	25 VIC
Garry Crick Auto Group	QLD, NSW	32 QLD / 5 NSW

Only **3 groups** (Eagers, Autosports, Servco) operate across 3 or more states; Eagers now spans **4 states** (QLD, NSW, VIC, WA) following the AHG acquisition. The market remains regionally fragmented — most groups are single-state operators.

Key Insights

- **Eagers Automotive dominates by volume.** 243,477 VINs across 22 dealers — **4.97% of all retail VINs**. Operates across 4 states (QLD, NSW, VIC, WA) including the former AHG Hyundai/Nissan/Mitsubishi sites in Osborne Park.
- **Servco Australia is the second-largest group.** 147,442 VINs across only 12 dealers — the highest VINs/dealer ratio among multi-site groups (12,287/dealer). Predominantly QLD, with Toyota and Lexus as core brands.
- **Autosports Group is the premium network.** 12 dealers, 100,468 VINs. All luxury/premium brands: BMW, Audi, Mercedes-Benz, Volvo, Jaguar. Operating across NSW, QLD and VIC — the highest-value portfolio in the network.
- **Garry Crick has the widest footprint.** 37 dealers — the most of any group — across **QLD and NSW**. Highly diversified brand portfolio with 24 unique makes.
- **Most groups are single-state operators.** Of the top 10 groups by VIN, only Eagers, Autosports, and Servco operate across more than 2 states. The Australian dealer market is regionally fragmented.
- **Concentration at the top.** Despite 329 unique named groups, the **top 10 groups account for 21.0%** of all retail VINs. The top 5 account for 14.0%. The market follows a long-tail distribution.

Data Quality & Validation

Dealer Existence — Activity Check

To confirm that proxy keys represent real, operating dealerships, every VIN in the Silver table was joined back to the Bronze delivery records and the most recent delivery date per dealer was extracted.

Activity Status	Proxy Keys	VINs	Notes
Active — 2024 or later	1,875	5,428,780	Confirmed operating
Active — 2023	27	1,122	Recent activity
Inactive — 2021–2022	43	16,387	Likely closed / rebranded
Inactive — 2019–2020	29	2,539	Discontinued brands
Old / no delivery date	46	2,378	Historical records
Total (excl. artifacts)	2,020	5,451,206	

94% of proxy keys had a confirmed delivery in 2023 or later. The 118 inactive proxy keys are almost entirely explained by brands that exited the Australian market — Holden (ceased Feb 2020), Chevrolet, Chrysler, JMC, SsangYong, HIGER Buses — not by data artefacts. Every proxy key in the enrichment table represents a real dealership that operated at the recorded address.

Post-Pipeline Audit Corrections

Following the automated resolution pipeline, a manual audit of T6 and T7 algorithmic clusters was conducted. The following corrections were applied directly to Snowflake and the source CSV:

Correction	Rows	Detail
Brian Hilton Motor Group	13	T6 UNRESOLVED cluster mixed West Gosford/NSW with Osborne Park/WA — split and web-verified
Eagers Automotive	1	Osborne Park Mitsubishi (AHG) was unresolved — confirmed via web
Blacklocks Automotive	6	“Indian Motorcycle Albury” was a wrong anchor name for Lavington/NSW Blacklocks sites
Bartons Motor Group	17	“Bartons Bayside” and “Bartons Wynnum” were the same corporate entity — merged
Perth City Auto Group	8	“Perth” geographic placeholder replaced with correct corporate name
Black Auto Group	7	“Black” placeholder — confirmed Armstrong family trading as Black Auto Group, Toowoomba
ARTIFACT (excluded)	108	Manufacturer dealer-locator pages (Holden, Jeep, KGM, GWM, GMSV, JMC, Isuzu UTE, JAC) — not physical dealerships
Total	160	